markets, including in terms of remittances and skill development. For all these reasons and more, foreign relations are intrinsically tied with India's domestic development.

Indeed, India already benefits from a bewildering array of international partners. The United States, European Union, Japan, United Kingdom, Gulf, and Singapore are important foreign investors in India. India sources energy from, among others, Iraq, Saudi Arabia, Russia, Qatar, Nigeria, the United States and UAE. It imports critical defence equipment from Russia, France, Israel, and the United States. A large number of Indian students receive their education at institutions in the United States, Canada, European Union, the Gulf, Australia ,and elsewhere. India's top export destinations include the United States, Gulf, European Union, China, Bangladesh, Singapore, and the United Kingdom. Strengthening and diversifying these partnerships will remain a crucial element of India's foreign relations, with direct implications for citizens at home. [1] Continued, sustained and productive diplomatic partnerships with advanced complementary economies—including, but not limited to, the United States, the European Union (and its member states), Japan, United Kingdom, Canada, Australia, the Gulf Cooperation Council, Russia, South Korea, Taiwan, Israel and Singapore—will remain a high priority for Indian diplomacy.

The world also presents India with risks and threats that must be mitigated, which is another reason for proactive international engagement. For example, other countries can offer sources of radicalization and safe havens for terrorists, hackers, and pirates. Competing economies often manufacture and export goods using unfair trade practices that undermine Indian industry and employment. As the Covid-19 pandemic showed, infectious diseases originating in other countries can easily spread to India. There is a temptation on the part of some Indian commentators to suggest that India should not distract itself with international affairs and focus only on its domestic economic and military transformation. But this view is not just simplistic, it is short-sighted, even dangerous. India—like almost every successful country in history—will have to proactively engage and manage